

07 Jan 2026 01:37:15 ET | 16 pages

NVIDIA Corp (NVDA.O)

CES Meeting Takeaways – Maintain Buy

CITI'S TAKE

We attended NVIDIA CEO keynote/financial analyst Q&A and hosted CFO Colette Kress for an investor meeting at CES. Overall, we walked away positive on reasoning led agentic and physical AI demand inflection in 2026. We were surprised to see Vera Rubin details at CES and believe Rubin architecture will enhance/surpass Nvidia's AI platform appeal vs Blackwell given increased architectural complexity with six new chips. The company sees upside to prior \$500B AI 2025/26 AI demand from both Blackwell and Rubin. We recommend investors add to NVDA as valuation looks attractive on ~19x next year earnings, demand visibility extends into 2027, and competition concerns esp. TPU lift post the Rubin ramp in 2H26.

Rubin Surprised Us Positively — Rubin is in full production now with release in 2H26. Cycle time is about 9 months+. The ramp is expected to be very fast. It's the only computer in the history where every chip is new. We expect NVDA to better manage supply hiccups with Rubin vs. Blackwell as the transition from Hopper to Blackwell required a full pivot in the way NVDA manufactured. That is going from a chip-based solution to a server-based solution. With Rubin sticking to the NVL framework we expect NVDA to have learnt from the Blackwell supply issues.

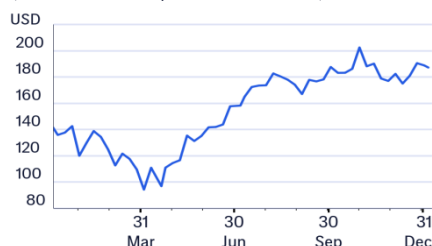
Groq IP will be Additive to TAM — Groq is very good at extreme latency and NVDA strength is very high throughput. The company is looking for a place to create something unique in the future. Management added that the acquisition will not affect core business but rather open something new.

Next Inflection of Token Generation — Reasoning is what drives 5x growth of token generation, but management expects 50x ahead because of agentic systems with tool use, planning and simulation, together with reasoning. Current frontier models are good enough for general use, but not from domain specific perspective, and Nvidia management expects to see many breakthroughs this year in vertical agentic systems.

Buy

Price (06 Jan 26 16:00)	US\$187.24
Target price	US\$270.00
Expected share price return	44.2%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	44.2%
Market Cap	US\$4,549,932M

Price Performance (RIC: NVDA.O, BB: NVDA US)



EPS (US\$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons	VA Cons
2025A	0.61A	0.68A	0.81A	0.89A	2.99A	2.99A	2.99A
2026E	0.81A	1.04A	1.30A	1.49E	4.64E	4.68E	4.71E
Previous	0.81A	1.04A	1.30A	1.49E	4.64E	na	na
2027E	1.66E	1.84E	2.13E	2.46E	8.10E	7.69E	7.67E
Previous	1.66E	1.84E	2.13E	2.46E	8.10E	na	na
2028E	2.47E	2.51E	2.54E	2.55E	10.08E	9.86E	9.58E
Previous	2.47E	2.51E	2.54E	2.55E	10.08E	na	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus. VA Cons: Visible Alpha Consensus.

Click [here](#) for Visible Alpha consensus data

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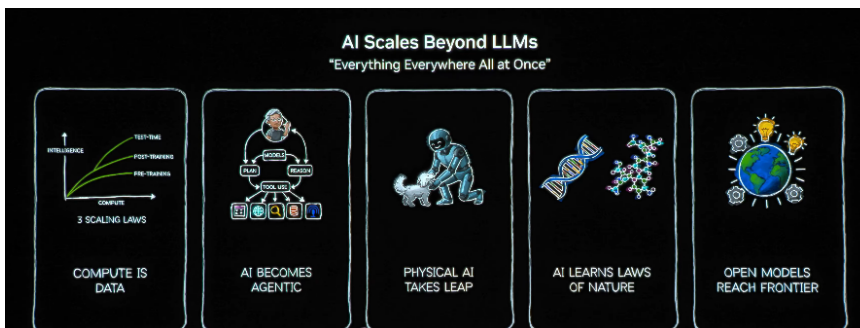
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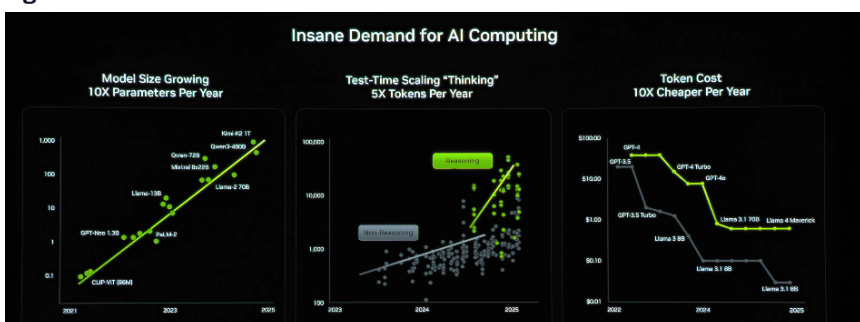
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Figure 1. AI Expansion



Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

Figure 2. Drivers of AI Demand



Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

I) Takeaways from Financial Q&A:

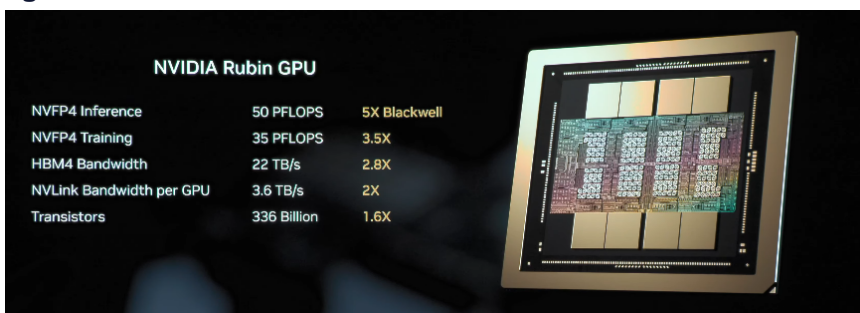
- **Vera Rubin:** management clarifies that Vera Rubin is in full production now and is still planning on 2H 2026 to be released to the market. Cycle time is about 9 months+. The ramp is expected to be very fast. It's the only computer in the history where every chip is new. Management is confident about maintaining GM in the guided range even with Rubin ramp, and in the longer term it links directly with the value they deliver.
- **Groq acquisition:** Groq is very good at extreme latency and NVDA strength is very high throughput. While latency and throughput are enemies of each other, the company is looking for a place to create something unique in the future. Management added that the acquisition will not affect core business but rather open something new.
- **Autonomous vehicle:** Nvidia started to work on AV 8 years ago, demonstrated the capability 5 years ago, and now it is in production with Mercedes. In the meanwhile, the company is also leveraging the technology and working with basically every robotaxi company, and even Tesla is using NVDA for their data center systems. It is about a\$5Bn-\$10Bn business currently but management sees it to grow significantly by the end of the decade.

- **Anthropic partnership:** Nvidia did not have the resources to invest in Anthropic in the early stage. Anthropic generates very high-quality tokens for enterprise, but generation rate is long, and that is where NVDA can be helpful. After Anthropic partnership, NVDA is now the only platform in the world that runs every model.
- **Supply chain:** Management is very confident about its supply chain relationships both up and down stream. The company is growing at fast scale and rate, and it prepares partners very early and supports them with prepayments to build out their capacity.
- **China:** The company has plenty of supply for all customers in all countries, particularly in the US, so that supply specific for China will not take away anything from other countries. Regarding H200, the government has received licenses and they are working on how to process those different licenses. From the company's perspective, they do have demand and just need to make sure to get approvals across different governments.
- **DGX Cloud:** It has always been located in CSP, and it was never intended to compete with them. It was strategically created that can prepare CSP for the new architecture and also can help attract customers. At the same time, Nvidia is also a frontier AI model builder, need a whole bunch of capacities itself, and can contribute tremendously to the ecosystem.
- **Context memory storage platform:** Nvidia is the largest networking company currently and management expects to be the largest storage processor company as well. Nvidia's BlueField with DOCA software is already adopted in CPU and networking, but the storage market is underserved right now. KV cache in AI data center is very heavyweight and cannot be supported by the old storage system, and BlueField-4 can open a new market.
- **Frontier model market:** Current models are probably good enough for general use, but not from domain specific perspective, and Nvidia management expects to see many breakthroughs this year in vertical agentic systems. Each model maker will have to find a specific channel that they can secure, and everything else will be open models.
- **Next inflection of token generation:** Reasoning is likely the reason that drives 5x growth of token generation, but management expects 50x ahead because of agentic systems with tool use, planning and simulation, together with reasoning.
- **M&A strategy:** The company's investment strategy (including R&D) is in every layer of the stack and across the industries, and up and down the supply chain. If there is something the company could do very uniquely, it will do it internally, and for investment outside, management prefers to keep Nvidia as small as possible and as large as necessary.

II) Key NVIDIA Announcements at CES 2026.

1) NVIDIA Rubin Platform — Six new chips to meet AI demand. NVIDIA launched at CES six new chips as part of the NVIDIA Rubin server— the Vera CPU, Rubin GPU, NVLink 6 Switch, ConnectX-9 SuperNIC, BlueField-4 DPU and Spectrum-6 Ethernet Switch. NVDA claims that the Rubin platform will deliver up to 10x reduction in inference token cost and train mixture-of-experts (MoE) models with 25% the number of GPUs, compared with Blackwell with each Rubin delivering 3.5x and 5x better training and inference performance than Blackwell respectively. While NVIDIA already announced the chips at GTC, the company mentioned that the chip is in full production. We expect NVDA to face less supply hiccups with Rubin vs. Blackwell as the transition from Hopper to Blackwell required a pivot in the way NVDA manufactured, going from a chip-based solution to a server-based solution. With Rubin sticking to the NVL framework we expect NVDA to have learnt from the Blackwell supply issues. Rubin-based products will be available from partners in the second half of 2026. Among the first cloud providers to deploy Vera Rubin-based instances in 2026 will be Amazon (AWS), Google (GCS), Microsoft (Azure) and Oracle (OCI), as well as NVIDIA Cloud Partners such as CoreWeave. In addition, Cisco, Dell, HPE, Lenovo and Supermicro are expected to deliver a wide range of servers based on Rubin products. AI labs including Anthropic, Meta, OpenAI among others are looking to the NVIDIA Rubin platform to train larger, more capable models and to serve long-context, multimodal systems at lower latency and cost than with prior GPU generations.

Figure 3. NVIDIA Rubin GPU

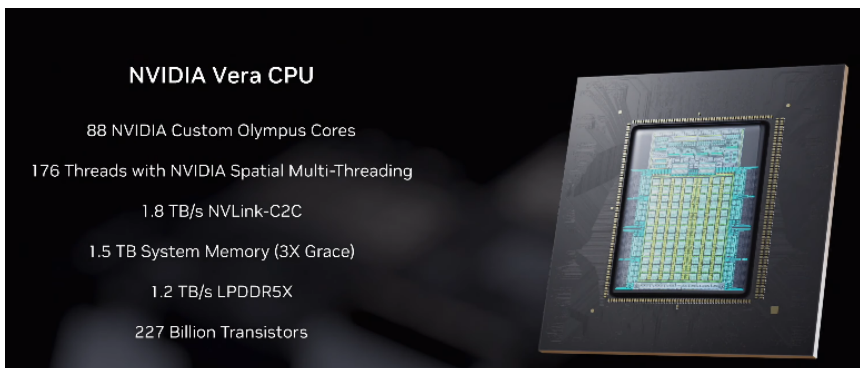


Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

In addition to the Rubin, NVIDIA announced the following:

- **Sixth-Generation NVLink Switch:** The switch is set to deliver a fast, seamless GPU-to-GPU communication required for today's ultra large models. Each GPU will offer 3.6TB/s of bandwidth, while the Vera Rubin NVL72 rack will reach 260TB/s.
- **Vera CPU:** The new CPU will be a considerable pivot from Grace as it will be built with 88 NVIDIA custom Olympus cores, full Armv9.2 compatibility and ultrafast NVLink-C2C connectivity, Vera delivers exceptional performance, bandwidth and industry-leading efficiency to support a full range of modern data center workloads.

Figure 4. NVIDIA's New CPU: Vera

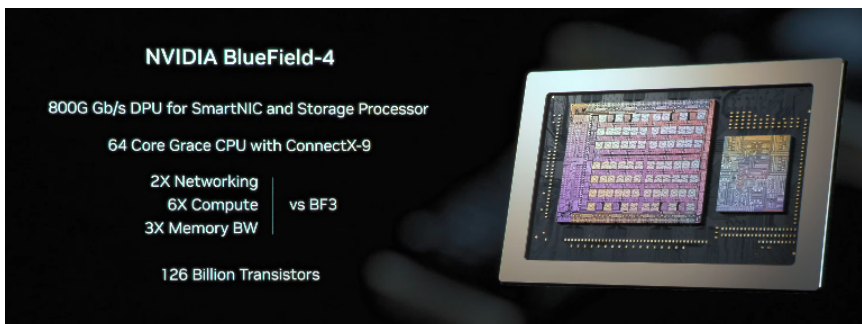


Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

- **Next-generation Spectrum-6 Ethernet** – enabled by 200G SerDes communication circuitry, co-packaged optics and AI-optimized fabrics – is built to scale Rubin-based AI factories with higher efficiency and greater resilience. Spectrum-X Ethernet Photonics co-packaged optical switch systems deliver 10x greater reliability and 5x longer uptime for AI applications while achieving 5x better power efficiency, maximizing performance per watt compared with traditional methods.
- **Third-Generation NVIDIA Confidential Computing:** Vera Rubin NVL72 is the first rack-scale platform to deliver NVIDIA Confidential Computing – which maintains data security across CPU, GPU and NVLink domains – protecting the world's largest proprietary models, training and inference workloads.
- **Second-Generation RAS Engine:** The Rubin platform features real-time health checks, fault tolerance and proactive maintenance to maximize system productivity. The rack's modular, cable-free tray design enables up to 3x faster assembly and servicing than Blackwell.

2) NVDA also announced its BlueField-4 which will power a new class of AI-native storage infrastructure for the next frontier of AI. Set to boost tokens per second and power efficiency by 5x. This platform provides the infrastructure for context memory by extending GPU memory capacity, enabling high-speed sharing across nodes, boosting tokens per second by up to 5x and delivering up to 5x greater power efficiency compared with traditional storage. Companies such as Dell, Supermicro, Pure Storage and HPE (all covered by Asiya Merchant) are among the first building next-gen AI storage platforms with BlueField-4, which will be available in the second half of 2026.

Figure 5. NVIDIA BlueField-4 Unlocks Storage



Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

3) Beyond new chips and hardware, NVIDIA also announced Alpamayo family of open-source AI Models and Tools to accelerate the next era of safe, reasoning-based autonomous vehicle development. Alpamayo introduces chain-of-thought, reasoning-based vision language action (VLA) models that bring humanlike thinking to AV decision-making – increasing driving capability in rare and complex scenarios, and critical to scaling trust and safety in intelligent vehicles. Rather than running directly in-vehicle, Alpamayo models serve as large-scale teacher models that developers can fine-tune and distill into the backbones of their complete AV stacks. Releases include 1) Alpamayo 1: the industry’s first chain-of-thought reasoning VLA model designed for AV research, 2) AlpaSim: an open source, end-to-end simulation framework for high fidelity AV development, and 3) Physical AI Open Datasets: 1,700+ hours of driving data collected across the widest range of geographies and conditions, covering rare and complex real-world edge cases.

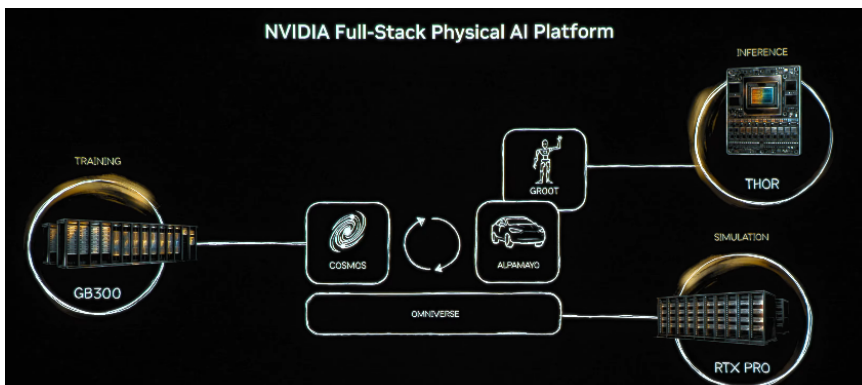
Figure 6. NVIDIA's New Open Model: Alpamayo



Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

4) NVIDIA also released new physical AI models as global partners unveil next-generation robots. NVIDIA today announced new open models, frameworks and AI infrastructure for physical AI, and unveiled robots for every industry from global partners. The new NVIDIA technologies speed workflows across the entire robot development lifecycle to accelerate the next wave of robotics, including building “generalist specialist” robots that can quickly learn many tasks.

Figure 7. NVIDIA's Physical AI Platform



Source: NVIDIA at CES 2026

Companies Mentioned:

NVIDIA Corp (NVDA.O; US\$187.24; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Alphabet Inc (GOOGL.O; US\$314.34; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Amazon.com, Inc. (AMZN.O; US\$240.93; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Cisco Systems (CSCO.O; US\$75.23; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 CoreWeave (CRWV.O; US\$77.94; 1H; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Dell Technologies (DELL.N; US\$123.93; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE.N; US\$23.79; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Lenovo Group (0992.HK; HK\$9.41; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:10)
 Mercedes-Benz Group AG (MBGn.DE; €61.45; 2; 06 Jan 26; 17:30)
 Meta Platforms Inc (META.O; US\$660.62; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Microsoft Corp. (MSFT.O; US\$478.51; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Olympus (7733.T; ¥2074.5; 1; 06 Jan 26; 15:30)
 Oracle Corporation (ORCL.K; US\$193.75; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Pure Storage, Inc. (PSTG.N; US\$69.03; 1; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)
 Super Micro Computer, Inc. (SMCI.O; US\$30.54; 2H; 06 Jan 26; 16:00)

NVIDIA Corp

Company description

Nvidia is a leader in graphics processing units or GPUs. It is engaged in creating graphics and networking chips, which are used in gaming, data centers, and automotive end markets. Nvidia was founded by Jen-Hsun Huang (current CEO) and partners in January 1993 and is headquartered in Santa Clara, CA.

Investment strategy

We like Buy-rated NVDA on secular AI growth opportunities.

Valuation

Our price target for NVDA of \$270 is based on ~30x P/E on C27E earnings power of \$10 discounted back. Our 30x P/E multiple is in-line with 3-5 year average.

Risks

Downside risks to the attainment of our target price include: 1) competition on gaming could drive the stock lower if Nvidia loses market share; 2) slower-than-expected adoption of new platforms can drive lower data center and gaming sales; 3) lumpiness in auto and data center markets can add volatility to the stock/multiple; and 4) cryptomining impact on gaming sales.

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Appendix A-1

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NVIDIA Corp (NVDA)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	23-Feb-23 02:35:10	1	*24.50	23.66
2	17-Mar-23 06:01:34	1	*30.50	25.73
3	23-May-23 08:08:33	1	*36.30	30.69
4	25-May-23 02:22:12	1	*42.00	37.98
5	17-Jul-23 01:50:06	1	*52.00	46.46
6	24-Aug-23 02:36:33	1	*63.00	47.16
7	18-Oct-23 00:32:40	1	*57.50	42.20
8	22-Feb-24 02:01:24	1	*82.00	78.54

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9	20-Mar-24 06:26:15	1	*103.00	90.37
10	23-May-24 02:55:03	1	*126.00	103.80
11	26-Jun-24 05:00:00	1	*150.00	126.40
12	12-Nov-24 08:00:00	1	*170.00	148.29
13	21-Nov-24 05:00:00	1	*175.00	146.67
14	05-Feb-25 08:00:00	1	*163.00	124.83
15	10-Apr-25 22:30:00	1	*150.00	107.57
16	29-May-25 01:37:50	1	*180.00	139.19

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
17	07-Jul-25 02:00:00	1	*190.00	158.24
18	28-Aug-25 01:41:01	1	*210.00	180.17
19	08-Sep-25 02:00:00	1	*200.00	168.31
20	30-Sep-25 04:04:43	1	*210.00	186.58
21	10-Nov-25 06:11:57	1	*220.00	199.05
22	20-Nov-25 02:46:50	1	*270.00	180.64

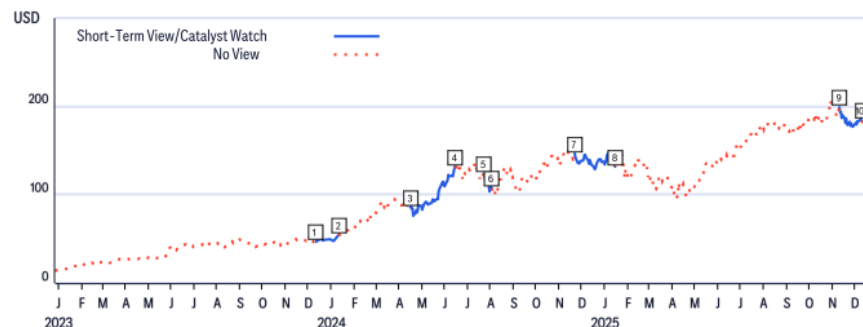
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

NVIDIA Corp (NVDA)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	11-Dec-23 08:11:55	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	46.63
2	10-Jan-24 11:06:14	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	54.35
3	15-Apr-24 01:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	86.00
4	16-Jun-24 21:00:00	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	131.88

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
5	22-Jul-24 01:00:00	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	123.54
6	04-Aug-24 14:08:32	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	107.27
7	21-Nov-24 00:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	146.67
8	14-Jan-25 02:06:50	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	131.76

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
9	10-Nov-25 01:11:57	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	199.05
10	10-Dec-25 11:07:18	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	183.78

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

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Data current as of 01 Jan 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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